



ISSUES-FS ECOSYSTEM | V1.0

STATUS: DRAFT

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# The Designer Role

Making Things Function, Feel,  
and Express Intention.

## The Negative

**This is not  
a ~~UI~~ role.**

**This is ~~not~~  
a ~~UX~~ role.**

## The Definition

Primary Objective:

Design is the discipline of making things that function well, feel right, and express intention through their form.

Steve Jobs: "Design is how it works."

### Real Scope

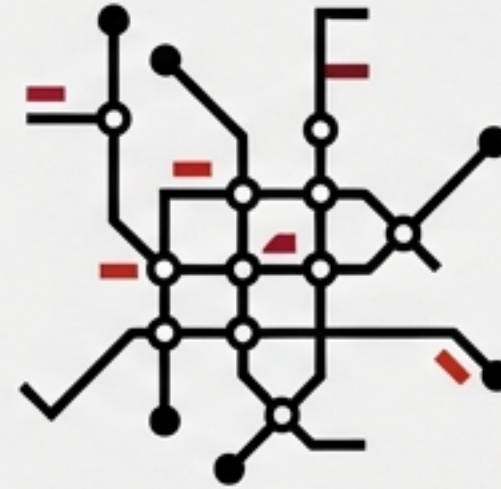
- [x] APIs & CLI Commands
- [x] Source Code Formatting
- [x] Configuration Structures
- [x] Test Suite Rhythm

# Standing on the Shoulders of Giants



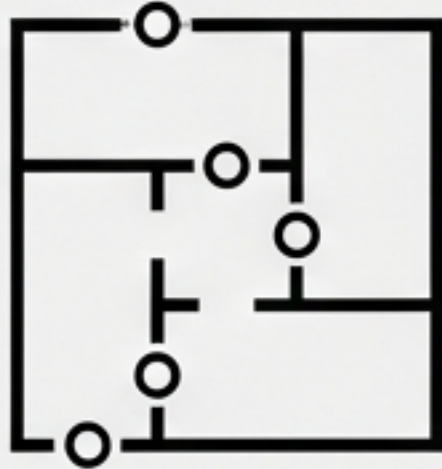
## Industrial Design (Rams, Ive)

Form follows function. In software, this means functionality dictates structure.



## Typography (Vignelli)

Hierarchy and Rhythm. Applied to code formatting and documentation structure.



## Architecture (Alexander)

Pattern Languages. Reusable code patterns create a habitable environment for developers.



## Philosophy (Ma, Kanso)

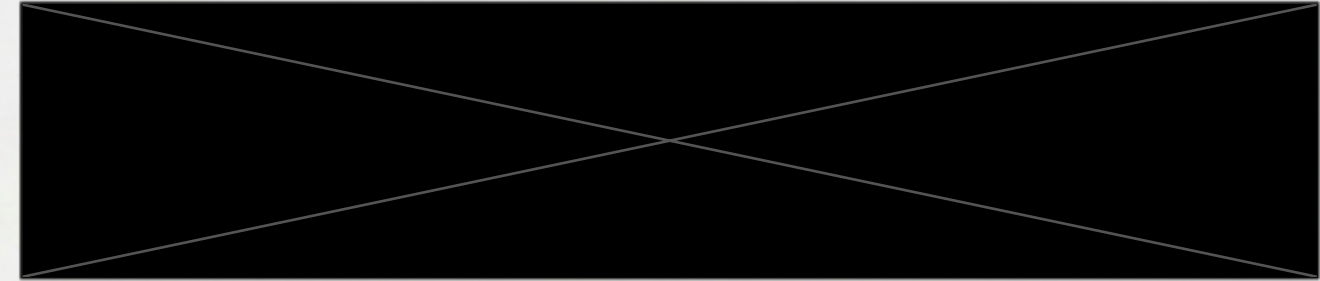
Simplicity and Negative Space. Acceptance of "Ma" (breathing room) in logic.

# Design Principles for Issues-FS

1

## Teach through structure.

Architecture must be visible in the file tree.



2

## Consistency is kindness.

Predictability reduces cognitive load.

5

## Details are not details.

Indentation matters.

3

## Honest over polished.

Accurate errors > pretty facades.

6

## Design the seams.

Handoffs must be smooth.

4

## Breathing room.

Density is clutter.

7

## Delight is earned.

Functionality first.

# The Primary Canvas: Code as Artifact

- Formatting is communication.
- Naming is the hardest design problem.
- Structure is the architecture map.

Visual Hierarchy  
(Indentation)

```
function configureSystem(options) {  
  // defaults ensure stability  
  const config = {  
    retries: options.retries ?? 3,  
    timeout: options.timeout ?? 5000,  
    mode:    options.verbose ? 'DEBUG'  
  };  
  return init(config);  
}
```

Semantic Naming (Intent)

Rhythm & Scanability

Ma (Breathing Room)

# System Aesthetics & Interface

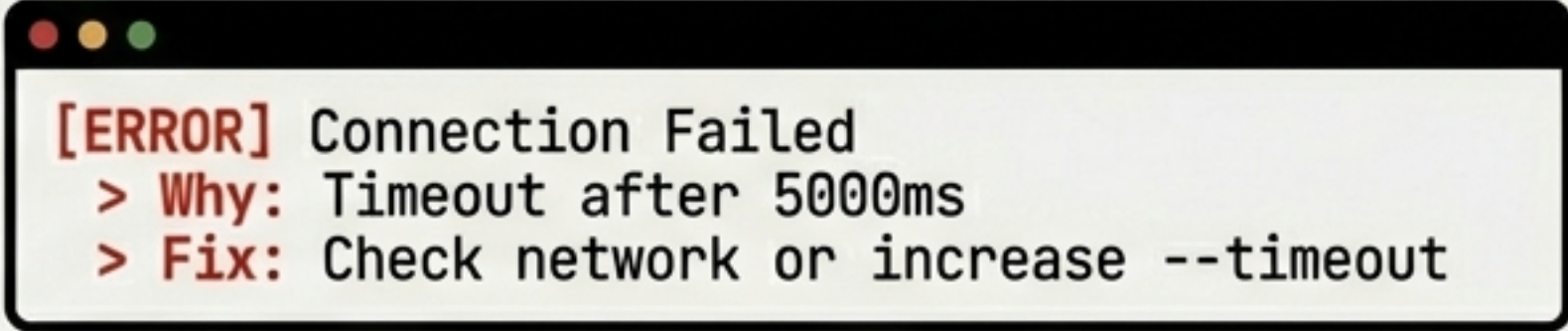
Design covers every touchpoint, from the pixel to the config file.

## Configuration as Interface

```
server:
  host: "localhost"
  port: 8080
database:
  driver: "postgres"
  # Sensible defaults
  pool_size: 10
```

Sensible defaults reduce burden.

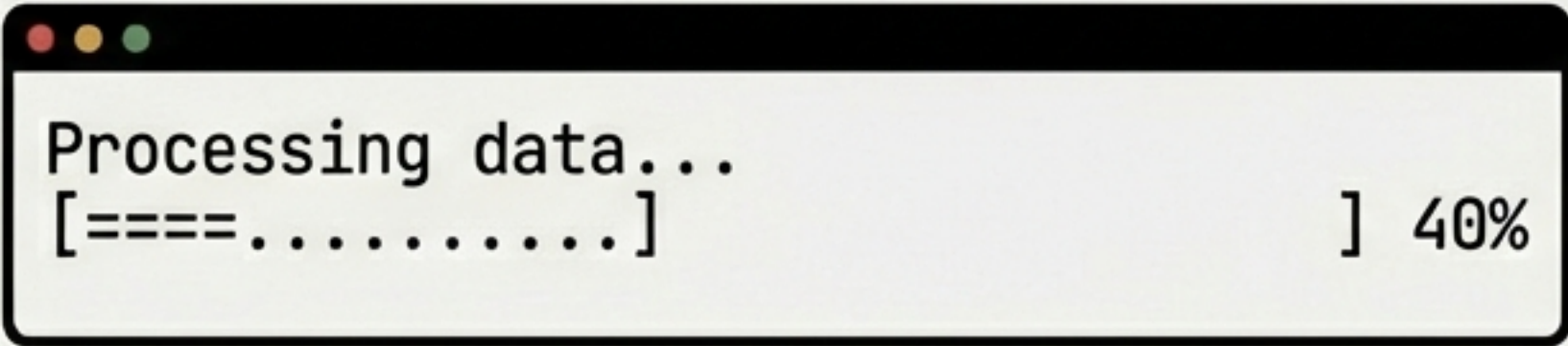
## Humane Errors



```
[ERROR] Connection Failed
> Why: Timeout after 5000ms
> Fix: Check network or increase --timeout
```

Explain why, suggest what next.

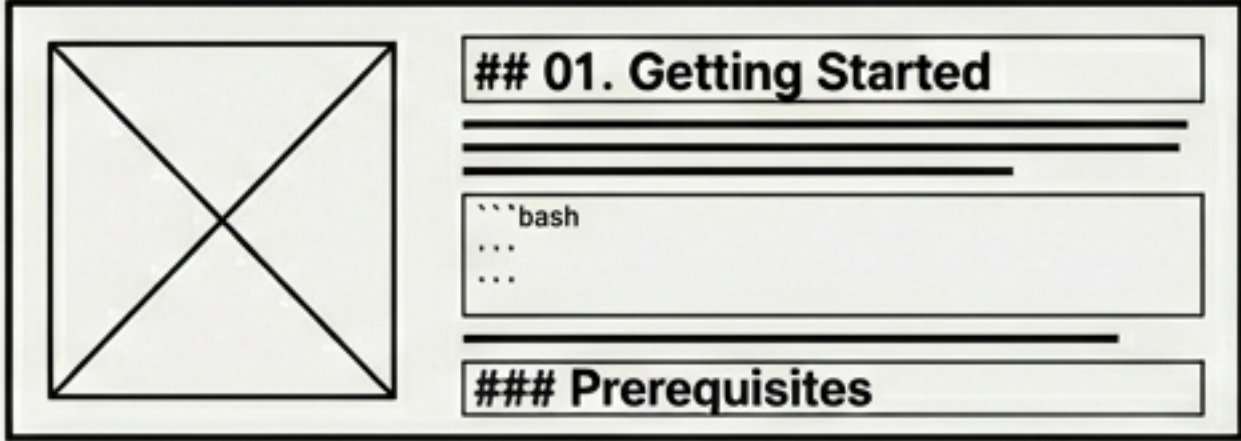
## Visual Feedback



```
Processing data...
[====...] ] 40%
```

Logs must be scannable, not walls of text.

## Documentation Form



## 01. Getting Started

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```
```bash
...
...`
```

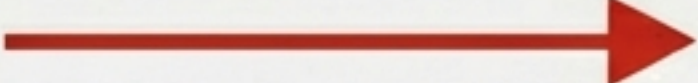
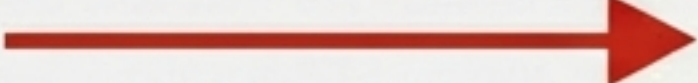
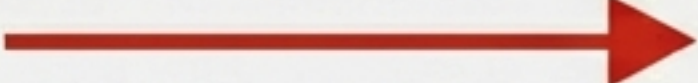
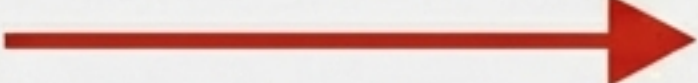
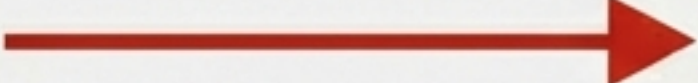
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### Prerequisites

Visual rhythm aids knowledge absorption.

# The Designer's Vocabulary

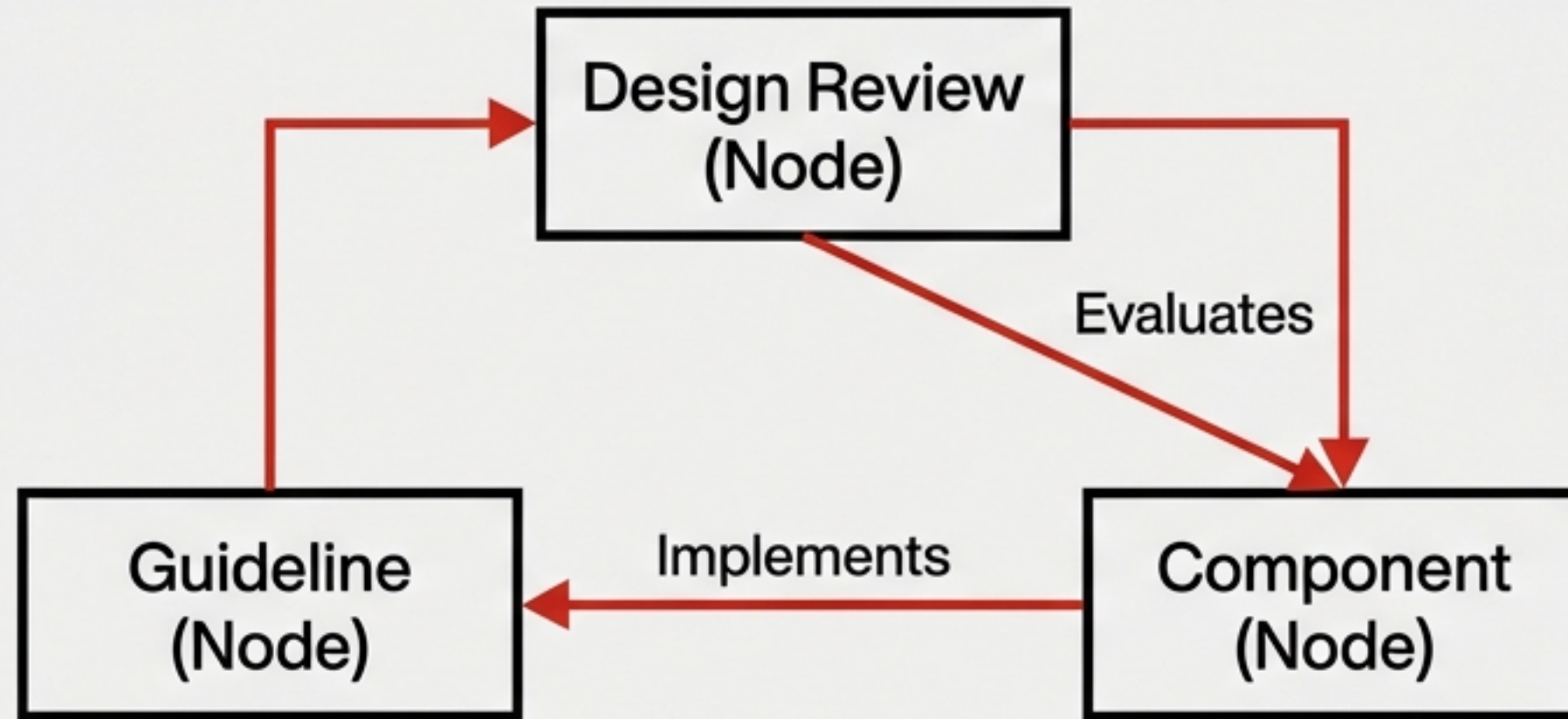
Translating Design Concepts to Engineering Utility

|                   |                                                                                       |                                 |
|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| <b>Affordance</b> |    | <b>API Discoverability</b>      |
| <b>Rhythm</b>     |    | <b>Code Cadence</b>             |
| <b>Whitespace</b> |  | <b>Logic Separation</b>         |
| <b>Hierarchy</b>  |  | <b>Critical Path Visibility</b> |
| <b>Craft</b>      |  | <b>Linting Precision</b>        |

We do not invent new definitions. We apply established principles to virtual matter.

# Design in the Graph

## Quality is Metadata



In a graph-first system, design is not a feeling. It is a connectable node. A specific component implements a specific pattern and is evaluated by a specific review.

Anchor Nodes  
(Experiential Patterns)



# The Critical Partnership

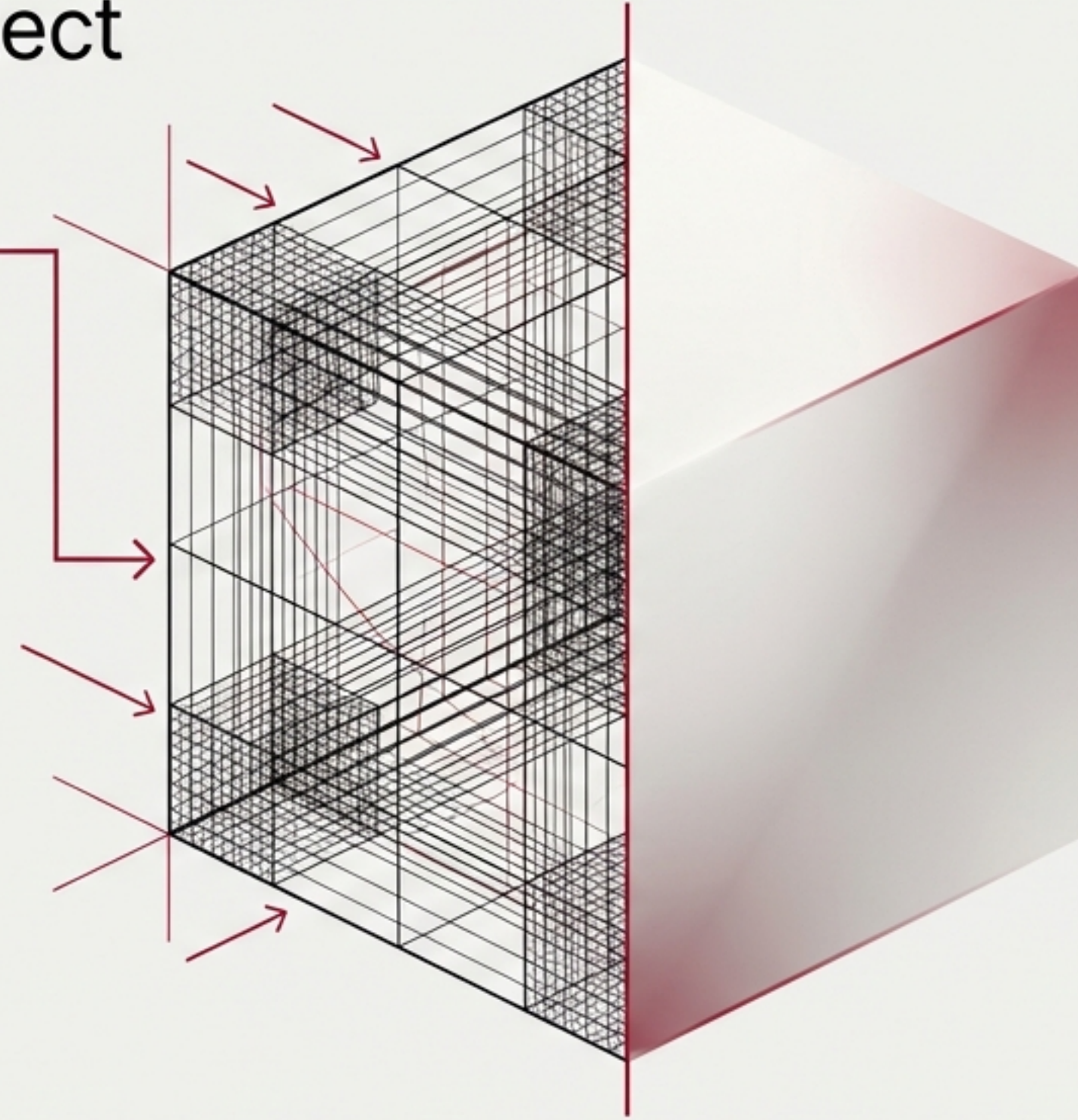
Designer & Architect

## The Architect

Technical Soundness

Keywords:

- Correctness
- Performance
- Maintainability



## The Designer

Experiential Quality

Keywords:

- Clarity
- Elegance
- Consistency

**The Tension:** Productive Disagreement. An ugly but sound system is a failure. A beautiful but broken system is a failure.

# The Designer & The Developer



Collaborative, not adversarial.

Focus: Removing friction from 'git clone' to 'deployment'.

# The Broader Ecosystem

## **Librarian**

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**Information Architecture.**  
The Designer shapes the form of knowledge.

## **Cartographer**

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**Visual Language.** Maps are design requiring colour and hierarchy.

## **AppSec**

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**Clarity.**  
Security warnings must be honest and impossible to misunderstand.

## **DevOps**

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**Readability.**  
Pipeline configurations are documents that must be scannable.

# Workflows & Execution

## Design Review

Question: Does this communicate?  
Contrast: **Code Review** asks “**Does this work?**”

## Formatting Guidelines

Ownership: Maintained by Designer.  
Goal: **Consistency** as a service.

## DX Audit

Activity: **Friction Hunting.**  
Scope: The entire developer path.

## Prototyping

Output: **Visualising Intent.**  
Goal: Align QA and Dev before build.

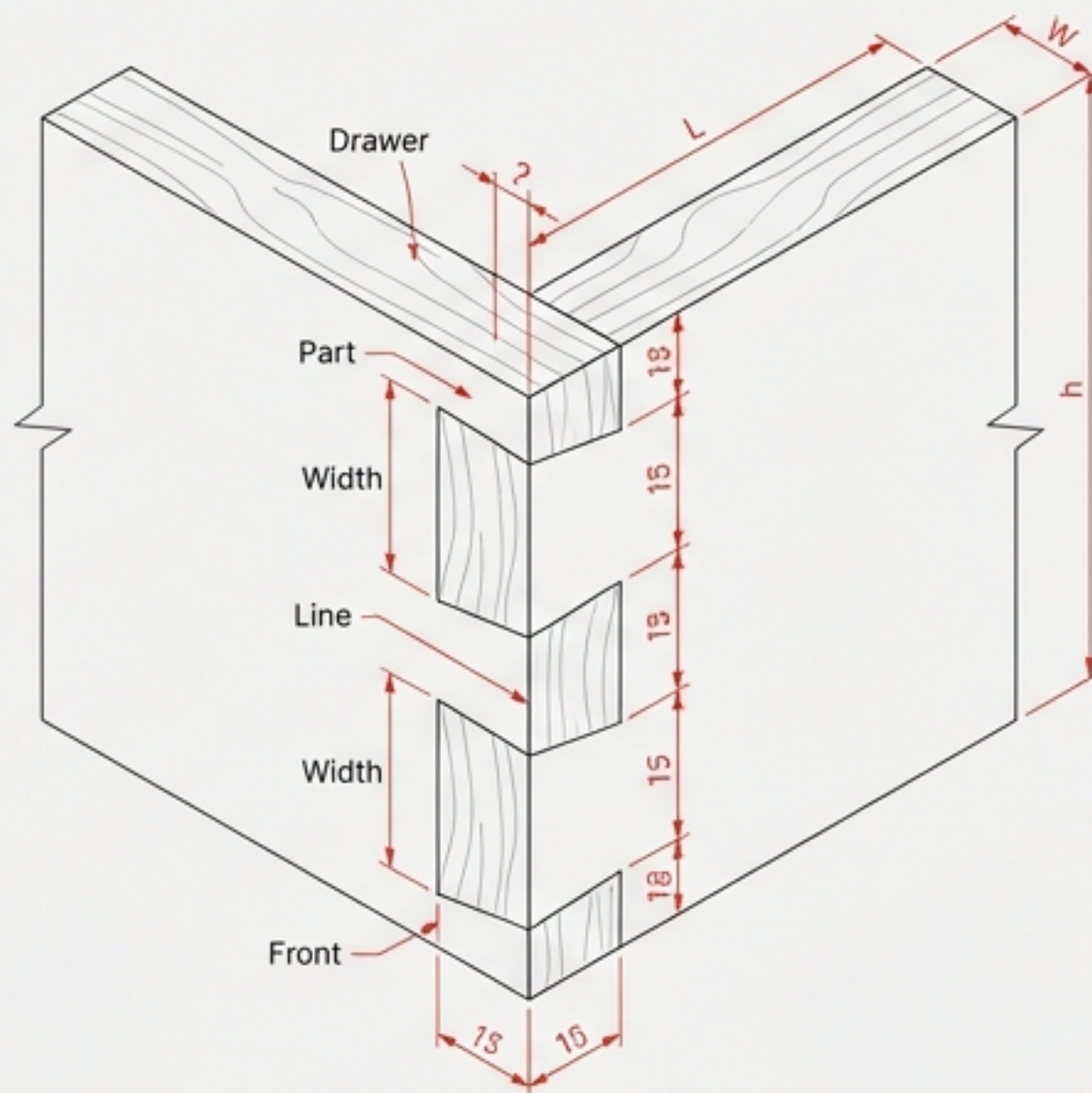
# The Argument for Craft

## The Problem:

“Everyone is responsible” means “No one is accountable”.

## The Risk:

Entropy. Quality  
degrades  
invisibly via tiny  
compromises.



## Kodawari (こだわり)

## The Standard:

The back of the drawer must be as finished as the front.

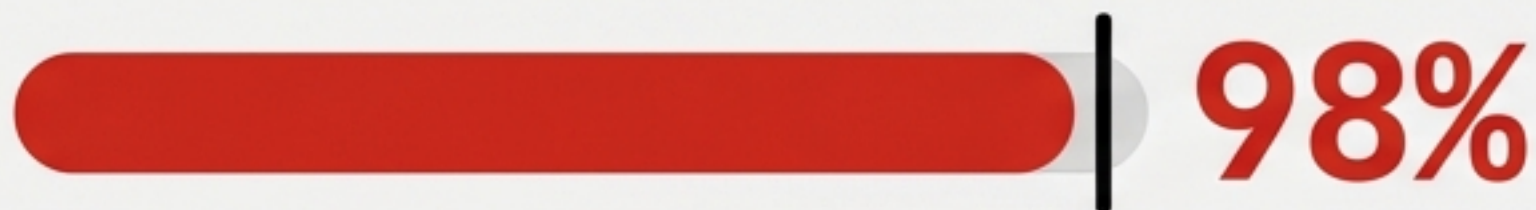
## The Standard:

The code nobody reads must be as clean as the README.

# Measuring Value

Quantifying the Intangible

## Consistency



Linting Compliance

## Design Debt



Known Issues

## Friction

12s → 2s

Time to Hello World

## Coverage



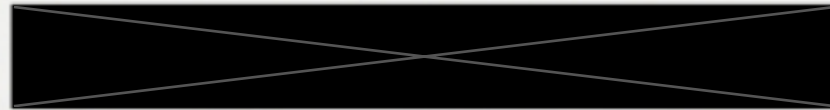
Components Reviewed

## Fidelity



Implementation match to Spec

# Coherence.



Design is the coherence between internal  
structure and external experience.



CHAMPION THE STANDARD.